

Envelope 03 · Rabi al-Awwal · The Cloak

Style C — **Paper Dunes**. Young Serif and Nunito Sans. Every word read from source; every drawing from tools/envelope_art.py, which has no figure in it.

Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

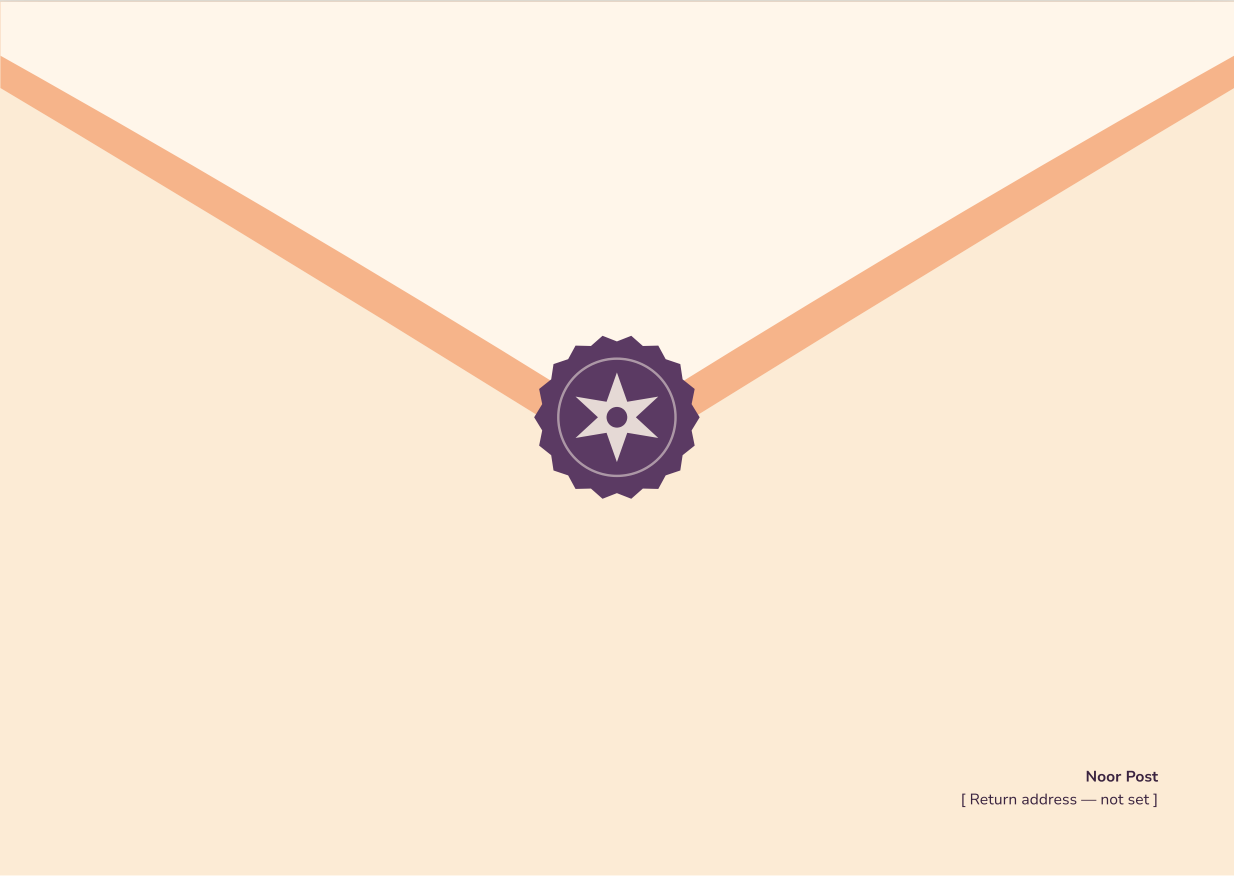
NOOR POST

One of fourteen. Open it on the day.



FOR

[Child's name]



INSIDE THE FLAP

ENVELOPE 03 • RABI AL-
AWWAL • INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

🕒 About twenty-five minutes

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The prints
- 4 Talk about it
- 5 The stickers
- 6 The postcard

THE LETTER — ONE A4 SHEET FOLDED TO A5

The Prophet Muhammad

(peace be upon him and his family)

B. ABOUT 570 CE, MAKKAH · D. 11 AH, MEDINA

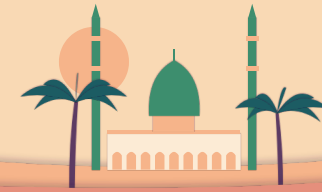
- **Where and when.** He was born in Makkah, a trading city in a dry valley with no river and no farmland, which lived on the caravans passing through it and on the pilgrims who came to the Kaaba.
- **Who was ruling.** Nobody. Makkah had no king. It was run by an assembly of the heads of its clans, which is why an argument over one stone could stop the whole city for four days — there was no one with the authority to end it.
- **Revelation.** Twenty-three years, from about the age of forty until his death. About thirteen of those in Makkah and ten in Medina.
- **What he left.** The Qur'an, complete. The community at Medina, which had been a set of quarrelling tribes and left an agreement in writing between them. And a road: the Hijra, from Makkah to Quba to Medina, still walked.
- **Khadija.** She ran a trading business of her own and sent caravans north under her own name. She employed him before she married him. When the early community had nothing, it was her money that carried it, and she spent it down to nothing doing so. *Traditionally, she was the first person to believe him.*
- **Elsewhere in the world.** In the same years the Kaaba was being rebuilt, work was going on in China on the Grand Canal, linking the great rivers so grain could move north. In Britain nobody was building in stone at all.

He died in Medina in 11 AH, in the house of Aisha, and was buried where he died.

Communities observe this differently. Ask your family which we follow. — his birth is kept on the 12th or the 17th of Rabi al-Awwal, and his death on 28 Safar or 12 Rabi al-Awwal.

[Work], [section] [number]. Translated by [translator], [publisher] [year].

The Cloak



● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

● Makkah was hot that year, and the Kaaba was broken. A flood had come down the valley and cracked the walls, so the families of the city pulled the old stones out to build it up again, higher than before.

○ Who was building it?

● Everyone. Every family took a wall. That was the point — nobody was going to let another family say they had built the House of God on their own. It went up fast.

● Then they came to the Black Stone.

○ What is the Black Stone?

● The stone set into the corner of the Kaaba. It is the oldest thing there, older than anyone could count back. It had to go into the new wall, and one man would carry it, and one family would be the family who did.

○ Everybody wanted to be them.

● Everybody wanted to be them. So for four days, nobody worked. Men sat in the shade with their arms folded and would not go near the wall. Then one family carried a bowl of blood into the courtyard and put their hands in it, which was how you said you would rather die than give way.

○ Over a stone?

● Over who they were.

THE CLOAK • CONTINUED

○ **Would you have given it up? Say it out loud before we go on.**

● Nobody there did. They argued until an old man said: let the next person who walks through that gate settle it. Everyone agreed, because nobody knew who it would be.

● They looked up, and it was Muhammad, thirty-five years old. No army. No title. Nothing but a name the city had given him, and when they saw him they said it out loud before he had said anything at all.

○ **What did they call him?**

● Al-Amin. The one you can trust.

● He listened. Then he asked for a cloak, spread it flat on the ground, and lifted the stone into the middle with his own hands. Then he told each family to take an edge.

○ **All of them at once?**

● All of them at once. They carried it to the wall together, and he set it into its place himself. Nobody had won. Nobody had lost.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

●○

**Four days of arguing.
One cloak.**



Then the hadith card.



THE PROPHET SAID



**“He who is deprived of
kindness is deprived of
goodness entirely.”**

The Prophet Muhammad

NOOR POST · THE FOURTEEN

The chain

It begins with him. Everyone else in this box is his family, and every chain of teaching in it runs back through this one man to the words he was given.



Fourteen segments · historical order

Segment number undecided — two schemes both number this card. The dot fills when it is fixed.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims, no. 112. Translated by Badr Shahin,
Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

SESSION CARD

Talk about it

About ten minutes. No right answers, and no points.

1

The families had been building together all week. What changed when they got to the stone?

2

• **Grown-up answers this one first.**

Tell about a time you wanted to be the one who did something, and someone else did it instead. What did you do?

3

In the letter you said whether you would have given it up. Now that you know how it ended — say it again. Same answer?

TURN OVER →



TALK ABOUT IT · CONTINUED

4

He could have carried the stone himself. Everyone would have let him. Why do you think he didn't?

5

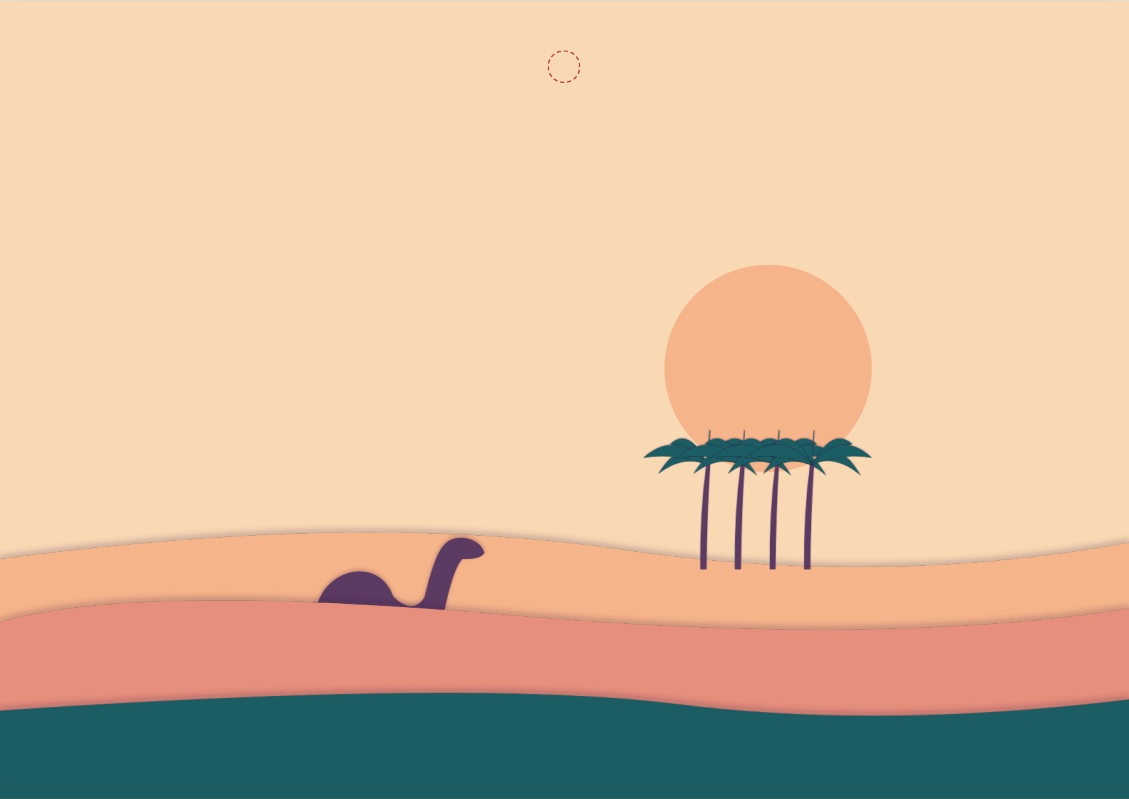
▮ **This one is hard for a grown-up.**

They trusted him before he had done anything for them that day. What had he been doing for the twenty years before it?

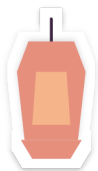
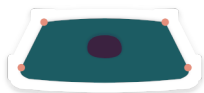
LAST

Find something in your house that two people have to carry.





STICKER SHEET — A6, KISS-CUT



RETURN POSTCARD — A6 LANDSCAPE



**We opened this one
together.**

● _____

○ _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
